

# Japan

April 8 – 22, 2026 · 15 Days · 13.5 Touring Days

Vancouver Tokyo (5 days) Kamakura Mt. Fuji Kyoto (3 days) Nara Osaka (3 days) USJ Vancouver

**OUTBOUND** ZG021 Zipair | YVR 10:30am Wed Apr 8 NRT ~12:40pm Thu Apr 9 | 10h 15m

**RETURN** ZG022 Zipair | NRT 15:55 Wed Apr 22 YVR ~08:30 Wed Apr 22 | 8h 35m

| Dates        | Area                      | Nights | Highlights                                                    |
|--------------|---------------------------|--------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Apr 8 (Wed)  | Travel — In the air       | —      | Depart YVR 10:30am, cross date line, lose 1 day               |
| Apr 9 (Thu)  | Arrive Tokyo              | 1      | Arrive NRT 12:40pm. Asakusa, Senso-ji, Skytree evening.       |
| Apr 10 (Fri) | Tokyo: Ueno & East        | 2      | Ueno Park, Ameyoko, Yanaka, Akihabara, Gotokuji, Koenji.      |
| Apr 11 (Sat) | Tokyo: Harajuku & West    | 3      | Meiji Shrine, Harajuku, Shibuya, Shimokitazawa, Shinjuku.     |
| Apr 12 (Sun) | Tokyo: Ginza & Waterfront | 4      | Tsukiji, Ginza, Imperial Palace, teamLab, Odaiba.             |
| Apr 13 (Mon) | Tokyo Disney (full day)   | 5      | DisneySea or Disneyland. Peak season — book ASAP.             |
| Apr 14 (Tue) | Kamakura + Tokyo catch-up | 6      | Great Buddha, Tsurugaoka, then Kiyosumi, Nakameguro.          |
| Apr 15 (Wed) | Mt. Fuji Kyoto            | 1      | Kawaguchiko AM, Shinkansen PM. Arrive Kyoto evening.          |
| Apr 16 (Thu) | Kyoto: Eastern temples    | 2      | Kiyomizu-dera, Philosophers Path, Gion, Sanjusangen-do.       |
| Apr 17 (Fri) | Kyoto: Northern temples   | 3      | Kinkaku-ji, Ryogan-ji, Ninna-ji, Nijo Castle, Nishiki Market. |
| Apr 18 (Sat) | Kyoto: Arashiyama + South | —      | Bamboo Grove, Fushimi Inari, Uji. Travel to Osaka PM.         |
| Apr 19 (Sun) | Nara Osaka                | 1      | Todai-ji, deer park, then Osaka Castle, Dotonbori.            |
| Apr 20 (Mon) | Osaka: temples & nature   | 2      | Shitenno-ji, Sumiyoshi Taisha, Kuromon, Minoo Falls.          |
| Apr 21 (Tue) | USJ (full day)            | 3      | Universal Studios. Super Nintendo World, Harry Potter.        |
| Apr 22 (Wed) | Travel home               | —      | Shinkansen OsakaTokyo, NEX to Narita, fly 15:55.              |

## Transit Passes & Essential Services

**Japan Rail Pass (14-day, ~¥80,000):** Covers ALL Shinkansen (Hikari & Sakura only, NOT Nozomi/Mizuho), JR local trains, Narita Express, JR buses. WARNING: ¥80,000 is NOT worth it for this trip! Activate at JR counter in Narita T1 arrivals. You need your passport.

**Suica / Welcome Suica IC Card:** Tap-and-go for all metro, buses, convenience stores, vending machines. Get at Narita airport machines or JR counter. Load ¥3,000–5,000 to start. Refill at any station machine or 7-Eleven. Also works with Apple Wallet (check compatibility).

**Kyoto Bus Day Pass (¥700/day):** Unlimited Kyoto city buses. Essential for temple hopping. Buy from bus driver on first ride or Kyoto Station info desk. Use Days 9, 10, 11.

**eSIM (Klook, ~¥2,000–4,000 for 14 days):** Get a DOCOMO or SoftBank eSIM on Klook before departure. Install QR code before flying. Activate on landing. Unlimited data plans available. No airport pickup needed — instant digital delivery.

**Visit Japan Web (FREE — [vjw.digital.go.jp](https://vjw.digital.go.jp)):** Japan's official online immigration + customs pre-registration. Complete 48+ hours before flight. Generates QR codes for fast-track at Narita. Skips paper forms entirely. Complete steps: create account register trip details fill disembarkation card customs declaration display QR code on arrival. Screenshots NOT accepted — need live site/app on phone. Have your eSIM active first so you have internet at the airport.

## Day 1 — Wednesday, April 8 — Travel Day

| Time        | Location / Activity          | Getting There (Exact Directions)        | What to Do / Tips                                                                                                                                                                           |
|-------------|------------------------------|-----------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 10:30a<br>m | <b>Depart YVR</b>            | ZG021 Zipair, Terminal M, Boeing 787-8. | Budget carrier: meals, blankets, bags extra. Pre-order meals on <a href="https://zipair.net">zipair.net</a> or bring your own. No in-flight entertainment — download to phone. USB at seat. |
| —           | <b>In the air (~10h 15m)</b> | Cross the International Date Line.      | Arrive tomorrow. Try to sleep — you lose a full calendar day.                                                                                                                               |

**Zipair Tips:** Low-cost. Pre-order meals or bring food from YVR. Bring neck pillow, eye mask. Download offline entertainment. Charge devices before boarding (USB at seat, no power outlet). Checked bag must be pre-purchased online.

## Day 2 — Thursday, April 9 — Arrive Tokyo Asakusa & East Side

| Time  | Location / Activity              | Getting There (Exact Directions)                                                                                                                           | What to Do / Tips                                                                                                                                     |
|-------|----------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 12:40 | <b>Arrive Narita T1</b>          | —                                                                                                                                                          | Immigration (show Visit Japan Web QR) + customs (show 2nd QR). 20–40 min with QR. Activate JR Pass at JR East counter, arrivals hall. Get Suica card. |
| 14:00 | <b>Narita Express Tokyo</b>      | Walk to B1 JR platform in Narita T1. Take N'EX (Narita Express) to Tokyo Station. ~53 min. JR ¥3,250 ea. way. Reserve seat at JR counter (free with pass). | Consider Takkyubin luggage forwarding counter near arrivals — send large bags to hotel (¥2,000, arrives same-day or next-day). Travel light.          |
| 15:15 | <b>Arrive Tokyo Station</b>      | Exit through Marunouchi Central exit.                                                                                                                      | Navigate to hotel. Drop bags or use coin lockers (¥400–700 in station).                                                                               |
| 16:30 | <b>Kaminari Mon Gate</b>         | From hotel: take Tokyo Metro Ginza line to Asakusa Station (exit 1). ~15 min from central Tokyo. Walk 2 min east to gate.                                  | Iconic red lantern gate, 11.7m tall. Free, always open. Photo: stand back to fit full gate.                                                           |
| 16:45 | <b>Senso-ji Temple</b>           | Walk straight through Kaminari Mon, along Nakamise St, ~3 min.                                                                                             | Tokyo's oldest temple (628 AD). Free. Draw omikujī fortune (¥100). Incense hall — waft smoke for good health.                                         |
| 17:15 | <b>Nakamise Shopping Street</b>  | 250m street between gate and temple. You walk through it naturally.                                                                                        | ~90 stalls: try ningyo-yaki (filled cakes), age-manju (fried buns), senbei. Shops close 5–6pm.                                                        |
| 17:45 | <b>Kappabashi Kitchen Street</b> | From Senso-ji, walk 10 min west (away from river) along Kappabashi-dori.                                                                                   | 170+ shops: Japanese knives, plastic food replicas, ceramics, kitchenware. Closes ~5:30–6pm. Great souvenirs.                                         |
| 18:30 | <b>Tokyo Skytree</b>             | Walk 15 min east along Sumida River from Asakusa. Or Tobu Skytree line from Asakusa Stn, 1 stop to Tokyo Skytree Stn.                                      | 634m, tallest tower in Japan. Book on Klook (¥2,100 Tembo Deck / ¥3,400 combo). Best at sunset/evening. Floor 450 observation.                        |

**DINNER (TBD):** Near Asakusa/Skytree. **Try:** Monjayaki (Tokyo's savory pancake, different from okonomiyaki). Restaurant:

**Also Consider:** Shibamata (retro merchant street, ~45 min NE, Keisei line to Shibamata Stn), Sunamachi Ginza Shopping Street (local shotengai, ~25 min east, Toei Shinjuku line to Nishi-Ojima Stn)

## Day 3 — Friday, April 10 — Ueno, Yanaka, Akihabara & West

| Time  | Location / Activity                   | Getting There (Exact Directions)                                                                       | What to Do / Tips                                                                                                               |
|-------|---------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 8:00  | <b>Ueno Park</b>                      | JR Yamanote line to Ueno Stn (Park exit). From Asakusa: Ginza line to Ueno (3 min).                    | Huge park. Cherry blossoms may linger in April! Free. Shinobazu Pond, temples, shrines inside.                                  |
| 9:30  | <b>Ameyoko Market</b>                 | Exit Ueno Park south gate, walk 2 min. Under JR elevated tracks, between Ueno & Okachimachi Stns.      | Seafood, dried fruits, spices, clothing bargains. Try: fresh fruit on a stick, chocolate-coated bananas.                        |
| 10:30 | <b>Yanaka Ginza / Yanaka District</b> | Walk 15 min north from Ueno Park. Or JR to Nippori Stn (1 stop north), west exit, 5 min walk downhill. | Old-town Tokyo, untouched by war. Cat-themed shops. Famous 'Yuyake Dandan' sunset staircase. Yanaka Cemetery with cherry trees. |
| 13:00 | <b>Kanda Myojin Shrine</b>            | JR Nippori Ochanomizu Stn (Chuo line, ~5 min). Walk 5 min south down hill.                             | Est. 730 AD. Anime/IT luck charms (Akihabara crowd). Free entry.                                                                |
| 14:00 | <b>Akihabara</b>                      | Walk 5 min south from Kanda Myojin, cross Kanda River.                                                 | Electric Town: anime, manga, electronics, multi-floor arcades (try Sega/Taito). Visit a maid cafe for the experience.           |
| 14:30 | <b>Animate Akihabara</b>              | Within Akihabara, 5 min walk east from main street (Chuo-dori).                                        | Multi-floor anime/manga superstore. Merch, figures, exclusive items.                                                            |
| 15:30 | <b>Don Quijote (Akihabara)</b>        | 3 min walk south on Chuo-dori.                                                                         | Discount megastore. Tax-free over ¥5,000 — bring passport! Souvenirs, snacks, electronics.                                      |
| 16:30 | <b>Gotokuji Temple</b>                | JR Akihabara Shinjuku (Chuo Rapid, 18 min) Odakyu line to Gotokuji Stn (7 min). Walk 10 min north.     | 'Lucky cat' (maneki-neko) temple. Hundreds of cat figurines. Buy one and leave it (¥300–5,000). Free entry. Very photogenic.    |
| 17:30 | <b>Koenji</b>                         | Odakyu back to Shinjuku (7 min) JR Chuo line to Koenji Stn (7 min). South exit.                        | Vintage/thrift shopping capital. Dozens of secondhand clothing shops, record stores, quirky bars. Non-touristy, local vibe.     |

**LUNCH (TBD):** Yanaka. **Try:** Kissaten (retro Japanese cafe) or Yanaka croquettes from street vendors. Restaurant:

**DINNER (TBD):** Koenji. **Try:** Local izakaya (Japanese pub). Restaurant: \_\_\_\_\_

**Also Consider.** Imdao Shrine (small shrine near Akihabara, niche), Nakano / Nakano Broadway (JR Chuo 1 stop west of Koenji — otaku shopping, retro toys, similar to Akihabara but less touristy)

## Day 4 — Saturday, April 11 — Harajuku, Shibuya & Shinjuku

| Time  | Location / Activity                | Getting There (Exact Directions)                                                                                | What to Do / Tips                                                                                                                                                       |
|-------|------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 8:00  | <b>Meiji Shrine</b>                | JR Yamanote to Harajuku Stn (Meiji-Jingumae exit). Walk 5 min through forest path from giant torii gate.        | Dedicated to Emperor Meiji. Massive grounds, towering forest. Free. Write wish on ema board (¥500). Weekend: may see wedding processions.                               |
| 9:15  | <b>Togo Shrine</b>                 | Exit Meiji Shrine east gate, walk 10 min east along Omotesando-dori, turn right.                                | Peaceful shrine with koi pond. Much quieter than Meiji. Free.                                                                                                           |
| 9:45  | <b>Takeshita Street</b>            | 3 min walk north from Togo Shrine to Harajuku Stn side. Entrance on JR bridge side.                             | Teen fashion mecca, crepes, kawaii culture, cotton candy. VERY crowded by 11am — go early.                                                                              |
| 10:30 | <b>Omotesando</b>                  | Walk south from Takeshita. Main boulevard running SE from Meiji-Jingumae crossing.                              | Tokyo's 'Champs-Élysées.' Flagship stores (Dior, LV, Prada), architect-designed buildings. Omotesando Hills mall.                                                       |
| 11:15 | <b>Yoyogi Park</b>                 | Walk 5 min west from Omotesando, enter from south gate.                                                         | On weekends: rockabilly dancers near entrance, cosplayers, live musicians. Free, wide open spaces.                                                                      |
| 13:00 | <b>Shibuya Crossing</b>            | Walk 10 min south from Yoyogi. Or JR 1 stop Harajuku Shibuya. Exit Hachiko exit.                                | World's busiest crossing. Watch from: Starbucks 2F (Tsutaya building) or Shibuya Sky. Photo: stand on island in middle of crossing.                                     |
| 13:30 | <b>Shibuya Sky</b>                 | Shibuya Scramble Square building, directly above Shibuya Stn. 14F entrance.                                     | 230m open-air rooftop deck. Book on Klook (¥3,000+). 360° views including Mt. Fuji on clear days. Allow 45–60 min.                                                      |
| 14:30 | <b>Center-Gai</b>                  | Exit Scramble Square, cross Shibuya crossing, straight ahead into Center-Gai.                                   | Busy shopping/eating alley. Quick walk-through 10–15 min.                                                                                                               |
| 15:00 | <b>Shimokitazawa</b>               | Keio Inokashira line from Shibuya Stn (Mark City bldg, 2F). 1 stop to Shimokitazawa (~3 min).                   | Indie/bohemian neighborhood. Vintage clothing, vinyl record shops, live music venues, specialty coffee.                                                                 |
| 16:30 | <b>Shinjuku Gyoen Garden</b>       | Odakyu or Keio from Shimokitazawa Shinjuku (~8 min). Walk 10 min SE to Shinjuku-Gyoemmae gate (Okido entrance). | ¥500 entry. Closes 6pm. No alcohol. English, French, Japanese gardens. Late cherry blossoms possible in mid-April!                                                      |
| 18:00 | <b>Kabukicho / Godzilla Head</b>   | Walk 10 min north from Shinjuku Gyoen through East exit.                                                        | Neon entertainment district. Godzilla head on Toho Cinema building (Kabukicho 1-chome). Robot Restaurant area.                                                          |
| 19:00 | <b>Golden Gai / Omoide Yokocho</b> | Golden Gai: 5 min walk E of Kabukicho. Omoide Yokocho: 5 min walk W, under JR tracks by west exit.              | Golden Gai: ~200 tiny bars (5–8 seats each), cover ¥500–1,000. Check signs for tourist-friendly bars. Omoide Yokocho: yakitori alley under JR tracks, smoky atmosphere. |

**LUNCH (TBD):** Harajuku/Omotesando. **Try:** Afuri ramen (yuzu shio) or Harajuku crepe. Restaurant: \_\_\_\_\_

**DINNER (TBD):** Golden Gai or Omoide Yokocho. **Try:** Yakitori (grilled chicken skewers) + highball. Restaurant: \_\_\_\_\_

## Day 5 — Sunday, April 12 — Ginza, Imperial Palace & Waterfront

| Time  | Location / Activity                        | Getting There (Exact Directions)                                                                         | What to Do / Tips                                                                                                                                                              |
|-------|--------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 7:30  | <b>Tsukiji Outer Market</b>                | Metro Hibiya line to Tsukiji Stn (exit 1). Walk 1 min east.                                              | BREAKFAST here. Tamagoyaki (egg omelet), fresh sushi, grilled seafood skewers. Stalls open 7–8am, busiest 9–11am.                                                              |
| 9:00  | <b>Ginza</b>                               | Walk 10 min south on Harumi-dori.                                                                        | Luxury shopping. Visit Ginza Six rooftop garden (free, 13F). Uniqlo flagship (12 floors!). Dover Street Market.                                                                |
| 9:30  | <b>Art Aquarium Ginza</b>                  | Within Ginza, Ginza Mitsukoshi building area.                                                            | Goldfish art museum. ~¥2,500. Beautiful photo-ops. ~30–45 min. VERIFY still open April 2026.                                                                                   |
| 10:30 | <b>Tokyo Station (exterior + basement)</b> | Walk 10 min north on Chuo-dori to Marunouchi.                                                            | 1914 red brick façade (photo from Marunouchi side). Underground: Character Street (official character shops) + Ramen Street.                                                   |
| 11:00 | <b>Imperial Palace East Gardens</b>        | Walk 10 min west from Tokyo Stn Marunouchi exit through Gyoko-dori.                                      | Free (closed Mon & Fri). Enter via Otemon gate. Moats, Edo castle stone walls, seasonal flowers. ~1 hr.                                                                        |
| 13:30 | <b>Zojoji Temple</b>                       | JR Yamanote to Hamamatsucho Stn (15 min from Tokyo Stn). Walk 10 min west.                               | Tokyo Tower framed behind main hall — iconic photo. Jizo statues with colorful pinwheels. Free entry.                                                                          |
| 14:30 | <b>Toyosu Market</b>                       | Yurikamome from Shimbashi Stn Shijo-mae Stn (~20 min). Follow signs.                                     | World's largest fish market (replaced Tsukiji inner market). Free viewing galleries of tuna auction area. Restaurants inside.                                                  |
| 15:30 | <b>teamLab Borderless</b>                  | Metro Hibiya line to Kamiyacho Stn (exit 5). Walk 2 min to Azabudai Hills entrance. Follow museum signs. | BOOK ON KLOOK 12 WEEKS AHEAD. ¥3,800. Allow 2–3 hrs. Wear pants (mirrored floors). No tripods. Download teamLab app for in-museum guide. Plain-colored clothing = best photos. |
| 18:00 | <b>DiverCity / Gundam</b>                  | Metro back to Shimbashi, Yurikamome to Daiba Stn (~25 min). Or taxi ~15 min.                             | Life-size Unicorn Gundam statue (19.7m). Free. Light show evenings (check schedule). DiverCity mall: food court, shops.                                                        |
| 18:30 | <b>Odaiba Seaside Park</b>                 | 5 min walk from DiverCity toward waterfront.                                                             | Rainbow Bridge views across Tokyo Bay. Nice at sunset. Free.                                                                                                                   |

**BREAKFAST:** Tsukiji Outer Market (graze: tamagoyaki, sushi, seafood skewers). Budget: ¥2,000–3,000

**LUNCH (TBD):** Tokyo Stn Ramen Street or near Imperial Palace. Restaurant: \_\_\_\_\_

**DINNER (TBD):** Odaiba or on the way back. Restaurant: \_\_\_\_\_

**Also Consider.** *Small Worlds Tokyo (Ariake, Yurikamome Ariake Stn — miniature theme park, 2–3 hrs, ~¥2,700), Sunshine City (Ikebukuro, JR Yamanote to Ikebukuro — shopping/aquarium/observatory), Ovoid Yokocho (small retro food alley)*

## Day 6 — Monday, April 13 — Tokyo Disney (Full Day)

| Time  | Location / Activity            | Getting There (Exact Directions)                                                                 | What to Do / Tips                                                                                                                                                      |
|-------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 7:30  | <b>Depart hotel</b>            | JR to Tokyo Stn. JR Keiyo/Musashino line to Maihama Stn (~15 min from Tokyo Stn). Follow crowds. | DisneySea recommended for adults (unique to Tokyo, more thrilling). Disneyland for classics.                                                                           |
| 8:00  | <b>Tokyo Disney park opens</b> | Scan Klook QR code at gate. Download TDR app before going.                                       | BOOK ON KLOOK ASAP. ¥7,900–10,900. April = peak cherry blossom crowds. Use TDR app for DPA (paid fastpass, ¥2,000/ride) and standby pass. Budget ¥10,000–15,000 total. |
| 21:00 | <b>Park closes</b>             | JR Keiyo line Maihama Tokyo Stn. Then to hotel.                                                  | Watch night show before leaving (Believe! at DisneySea, Harmonius at Disneyland).                                                                                      |

**LUNCH & DINNER:** Inside park. DisneySea: Vulcania Restaurant, Zambini Brothers. Disneyland: Queen of Hearts Banquet.

## Day 7 — Tuesday, April 14 — Kamakura Day Trip + Tokyo Catch-up

| Time  | Location / Activity             | Getting There (Exact Directions)                                                                                            | What to Do / Tips                                                                                                      |
|-------|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 8:00  | <b>Depart Tokyo</b>             | JR Yokosuka line from Tokyo Stn or Shinagawa Stn. Kamakura Stn (~1 hr). JR Pass covered.                                    | Ancient capital (1185–1333). ~30 temples/shrines. We hit the highlights.                                               |
| 9:15  | <b>Tsurugaoka Hachimangu</b>    | 10 min walk straight N from Kamakura Stn along Wakamiya Oji (shop-lined boulevard).                                         | Kamakura's most important shrine (1063). Free. Dramatic stone staircase to main hall. Museum inside (¥200).            |
| 10:30 | <b>Great Buddha (Kotoku-in)</b> | Enoden tram from Kamakura Stn. Hase Stn (3 stops, ~10 min). Walk 10 min north uphill.                                       | 13.35m bronze Buddha (1252). ¥300 entry. Go INSIDE the hollow statue for ¥50! Great photo from slightly below.         |
| 12:00 | <b>Komachi-dori lunch</b>       | Enoden back to Kamakura Stn. Komachi-dori is the main shopping street, 1 min from east exit.                                | Restaurant street + souvenir shops. Try shirasu-don (whitebait bowl) — Kamakura's specialty.                           |
| 13:30 | <b>Explore coast / Enoshima</b> | Enoden tram from Kamakura. ride the full scenic line along coast.                                                           | Enoden itself is worth riding — runs past ocean, through narrow streets between houses. 25 min end to end.             |
| 15:30 | <b>Return to Tokyo</b>          | JR Yokosuka Kamakura Tokyo Stn (~1 hr). JR Pass.                                                                            |                                                                                                                        |
| 17:00 | <b>Kiyosumi Garden</b>          | Metro Oedo line to Kiyosumi-Shirakawa Stn (exit A3). Walk 3 min.                                                            | Edo-period strolling garden. ¥150. Closes 5pm (enter by 4:30). Stepping stones, koi, teahouse.                         |
| 18:00 | <b>Nakameguro Canal</b>         | Tokyu Toyoko line from Naka-Meguro interchange (~20 min from Kiyosumi area).                                                | Meguro River: cherry blossom lined canal (may still have late blooms). Trendy cafes, boutiques. Walk along both banks. |
| 19:00 | <b>Todoroki Valley</b>          | Tokyu Oimachi line from Jiyugaoka Stn to Todoroki Stn (~10 min from Nakameguro). South exit, 2 min walk to valley entrance. | Tokyo's only ravine gorge. Hidden green valley, stream, small shrine at end. 20 min walk through. Free.                |

**LUNCH (TBD):** Kamakura Komachi-dori. **Try:** Shirasu-don (whitebait rice bowl, local specialty). Restaurant: \_\_\_\_\_  
**DINNER (TBD):** Nakameguro area. Restaurant: \_\_\_\_\_

## Day 8 — Wednesday, April 15 — Mt. Fuji Shinkansen to Kyoto

**CHECK OUT** of Tokyo hotel. Send main luggage to Kyoto hotel via Takkyubin (~¥2,000, arrange at hotel front desk night before). Take daypack only to Mt. Fuji.

| Time  | Location / Activity         | Getting There (Exact Directions)                                                                                                                        | What to Do / Tips                                                                                                                                             |
|-------|-----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 7:00  | <b>Depart Shinjuku</b>      | Highway bus from Shinjuku Expressway Bus Terminal (Busta Shinjuku, 4F) Kawaguchiko Stn. ~1hr45. ¥2,200 one-way. Book on highway-buses.jp or Klook.      | Bus is faster/cheaper than train. Buy round-trip ticket.                                                                                                      |
| 9:00  | <b>Kawaguchiko area</b>     | Local Retro Bus (Red Line) from Kawaguchiko Stn. ¥150-300/ride or day pass ¥1,500.                                                                      | Lake + Fuji reflection views. Chureito Pagoda: take bus to Shimoyoshida (20 min) then climb 398 steps. Best views early AM, clear weather.                    |
| 11:00 | <b>Mt. Fuji 5th Station</b> | Bus from Kawaguchiko Stn (~50 min, ¥1,540 each way). Check road status at fujiyama-navi.jp.                                                             | 2,305m altitude. COLD even in April — bring warm layer. Road may be closed for snow early April. If closed: stay at Kawaguchiko, visit Oshino Hakkai instead. |
| 14:00 | <b>Return to Shinjuku</b>   | Highway bus Kawaguchiko Shinjuku (~1hr45).                                                                                                              |                                                                                                                                                               |
| 16:30 | <b>Shinkansen to Kyoto</b>  | JR Chuo Rapid from Shinjuku Tokyo Stn (15 min). Hikari Shinkansen Tokyo Kyoto ~2hr40. JR Pass (NOT Nozomi). Reserve seat via SmartEX app or at station. | Buy ekiben (station bento box) at Tokyo Stn for dinner on the train! Gransta underground has dozens of choices.                                               |
| 19:00 | <b>Arrive Kyoto</b>         | Exit Kyoto Stn central gate.                                                                                                                            | Check into hotel. Luggage should arrive via Takkyubin.                                                                                                        |
| 19:30 | <b>Evening stroll: Gion</b> | Walk or bus #206 from Kyoto Stn to Gion (~15 min).                                                                                                      | May spot geiko/geisha. Observe respectfully — don't block, don't touch, don't chase.                                                                          |

**LUNCH (TBD):** Kawaguchiko. **Try:** Houtou noodles (thick wheat noodles in miso, Yamanashi specialty). Restaurant:

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**DINNER:** Ekiben on Shinkansen (buy at Tokyo Station Gransta). Or Kyoto upon arrival. -----



## Day 9 — Thursday, April 16 — Kyoto: Eastern Temples & Gion

| Time  | Location / Activity               | Getting There (Exact Directions)                                                                              | What to Do / Tips                                                                                                           |
|-------|-----------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 7:00  | <b>Kiyomizu-dera</b>              | Kyoto Bus #206 from Kyoto Stn (stand D2) Kiyomizu-michi stop (~15 min). Walk 10 min uphill on Matsubara-dori. | GO AT OPENING (6am year-round but 7am ideal). Packed by 9am. ¥500. Famous wooden stage (13m) + city views. Cherry blossoms. |
| 8:30  | <b>Sannenzaka &amp; Ninenzaka</b> | Walk downhill from Kiyomizu-dera main gate, bear right.                                                       | Preserved Edo-era stone-paved slopes. Legend: stumble on Ninenzaka = 2 years bad luck! Shops, cafes.                        |
| 9:00  | <b>Starbucks Ninenzaka</b>        | On Ninenzaka slope, look for traditional machiya (townhouse) facade.                                          | 100-year-old machiya converted to Starbucks. Tatami seating upstairs, zen garden. Unique.                                   |
| 9:30  | <b>Yasaka Pagoda (Hokan-ji)</b>   | Continue walking north 3 min from Ninenzaka.                                                                  | Iconic 5-story pagoda. Classic Kyoto postcard photo — best from the street looking up.                                      |
| 9:45  | <b>Ishibei-koji Alley</b>         | Walk 5 min south from Yasaka Pagoda, between Kodai-ji and Yasaka Shrine.                                      | Beautiful cobblestone alley with traditional ryokan walls. Atmospheric, quiet. Quick walk-through 5 min.                    |
| 10:15 | <b>Kodai-ji Temple</b>            | Walk 5 min north from Ishibei-koji, follow signs.                                                             | Zen temple with beautiful gardens (raked sand, moss). ¥600. Night illuminations in spring (check dates). ~30–45 min.        |
| 11:15 | <b>Chion-in Sanmon Gate</b>       | Walk 10 min north along Higashiyama.                                                                          | Japan's LARGEST wooden gate (24m). Jodo-shu headquarters. Nightingale floors (squeak to detect ninjas). Free grounds.       |
| 13:00 | <b>Nanzen-ji Temple</b>           | Walk 15 min east from Chion-in, through Maruyama Park.                                                        | Major Zen temple. Famous brick aqueduct (Roman-style, free to see). ¥600 for Hojo hall & gardens. Rock garden.              |
| 14:15 | <b>Philosophers Path</b>          | Walk north from Nanzen-ji along canal. Path runs ~2km N to Ginkaku-ji area.                                   | Canal-side path lined with cherry trees (late petals possible). Small temples, cafes, cat cafes along way. 30–45 min walk.  |
| 15:30 | <b>Gion District</b>              | Bus #5 or #100 from Ginkaku-ji-michi stop to Gion (~15 min). Or walk west 20 min.                             | Geisha district. Walk along Shirakawa canal (white willow trees). Tatsumi Bridge — classic photo spot.                      |
| 16:00 | <b>Hanamikoji Street</b>          | Within Gion, main street running N-S. Enter from Shijo-dori.                                                  | Best spot for geiko/maiko sightings: 5–6pm when they walk to evening engagements.                                           |
| 17:00 | <b>Sanjusangen-do</b>             | Bus #206/#208 south from Gion (~10 min) to Sanjusangendo-mae stop.                                            | 1,001 golden Kannon statues in a 120m hall. ¥600. No photos inside. Stunning scale. 30–45 min.                              |

**LUNCH (TBD):** Gion area. **Try:** Yudofu (hot tofu, Kyoto specialty) or matcha parfait at a traditional teahouse. Restaurant:

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**DINNER (TBD):** Pontocho Alley (narrow alley parallel to Kamo River, west of Gion). River-side terrace dining in summer. Restaurant:

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## Day 10 — Friday, April 17 — Kyoto: Northern Temples

| Time  | Location / Activity                 | Getting There (Exact Directions)                                                         | What to Do / Tips                                                                                                            |
|-------|-------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 8:00  | <b>Kinkaku-ji (Golden Pavilion)</b> | Bus #205 from Kyoto Stn (stand B3) Kinkakuji-michi stop (~35 min). Walk 5 min. Go early! | ¥500. Gold-leaf covered pavilion reflected in mirror pond. Your 'ticket' is a calligraphy charm (keep it)! ~30 min.          |
| 9:15  | <b>Ryoan-ji</b>                     | Bus #59 from Kinkakuji-michi Ryoanji-mae (5 min). Or walk 15 min west.                   | Famous Zen rock garden: 15 stones on white gravel, never all visible from one point. ¥500. ~30 min.                          |
| 10:15 | <b>Ninna-ji</b>                     | Walk 10 min west from Ryoan-ji along Kinukake-no-michi.                                  | UNESCO site. Late-blooming Omuro cherry blossoms (shorter trees, eye-level) — may catch them mid-April! ¥800 for garden.     |
| 11:15 | <b>Kitano Tenmangu</b>              | Bus #10/#26 from Omuro-Ninnaji stop Kitano-Tenmangu-mae (~10 min).                       | Shrine of learning/scholars. Free. Flea market on 25th each month. Beautiful plum grove.                                     |
| 13:00 | <b>Daitoku-ji</b>                   | Bus or walk 15 min east from Kitano.                                                     | Vast Zen complex. Visit sub-temples: Zuiho-in (¥400, modern rock garden), Koto-in (¥400, maple-lined approach). ~1 hr total. |
| 14:30 | <b>Nijo Castle</b>                  | Bus #9/#12 south from Daitoku-ji (~20 min) to Nijo-jo-mae.                               | Tokugawa shogun's residence. ¥1,300. Nightingale floors (squeak = anti-ninja!). Stunning painted screens. ~1 hr.             |
| 16:00 | <b>Nishiki Market</b>               | Walk 10 min east from Nijo Castle to Nishiki-koji-dori.                                  | Kyoto's Kitchen. 130+ stalls: pickles, dashi, matcha sweets, octopus skewers, soy milk donuts. Graze your way through.       |

**LUNCH (TBD):** Near Kitano Tenmangu. **Try:** Obanzai (Kyoto home-style dishes). Restaurant: \_\_\_\_\_

**DINNER (TBD):** Nishiki Market grazing for appetizers, then Pontocho/Gion for main dinner. Restaurant: \_\_\_\_\_

**Also Consider.** Genko-an (far N, bus #6 to Takagamine, 'windows of enlightenment' — round/square frames), Myoshin-ji (large Zen complex near Ninna-ji, free grounds, paid sub-temples)

## Day 11 — Saturday, April 18 — Arashiyama, Fushimi Inari & Uji

| Time  | Location / Activity                          | Getting There (Exact Directions)                                                                               | What to Do / Tips                                                                                                                                      |
|-------|----------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 6:30  | <b>Arashiyama Bamboo Grove</b>               | JR Sagano/San-in line from Kyoto Stn<br>Saga-Arashiyama Stn (~15 min). JR Pass. Walk<br>10 min north to grove. | ARRIVE AT DAWN. Shoulder-to-shoulder by 9am.<br>Towering bamboo tunnels. Free. Photos: look UP,<br>include the path curving ahead.                     |
| 7:00  | <b>Tenryu-ji Temple</b>                      | Main gate is 2 min walk south from bamboo<br>grove exit.                                                       | UNESCO site (1339). Garden designed by Muso Soseki.<br>¥500. Enter from garden side for best experience.                                               |
| 8:00  | <b>Jojakko-ji</b>                            | Walk 15 min north uphill from Tenryu-ji, past<br>bamboo grove.                                                 | Hillside temple with moss-covered grounds, pagoda<br>with mountain views. ¥500. Quieter than main area.                                                |
| 8:45  | <b>Nison-in</b>                              | 5 min walk further north/east.                                                                                 | Beautiful year-round garden temple. ¥500. Two<br>Amida Buddha statues inside.                                                                          |
| 9:15  | <b>Gio-ji</b>                                | 10 min walk NW from Nison-in.                                                                                  | Tiny thatched-roof temple, carpet of green moss.<br>¥300. Connected to a tragic love story. Very<br>photogenic.                                        |
| 10:00 | <b>Togetsukyo Bridge</b>                     | Walk 15 min south back to main Arashiyama<br>river area.                                                       | Iconic wooden bridge, Oi River, mountains behind.<br>Free. Great photo spot. Boat rentals available.                                                   |
| 10:15 | <b>Kimono Forest</b>                         | Walk 5 min east to Randen Arashiyama Stn.                                                                      | 600 illuminated kimono fabric poles lining the path.<br>Free. Even better at night (lit up).                                                           |
| 10:30 | <b>Iwatayama Monkey Park</b>                 | From Togetsukyo Bridge south side, walk 5<br>min to park entrance. Then 20 min uphill hike.                    | ~120 wild Japanese macaques. ¥550. Feed them from<br>inside a mesh hut (¥100). Panoramic Kyoto views from<br>top.                                      |
| 13:30 | <b>Fushimi Inari Taisha</b>                  | JR Sagano from Saga-Arashiyama Kyoto<br>Stn JR Nara line to Inari Stn (2 min walk). ~30<br>min total.          | Thousands of orange torii gates up Mt. Inari. FREE. Full<br>hike: 2–3 hrs. First 30 min (to Yotsutsuji intersection) is<br>the best part. Great views. |
| 16:00 | <b>Byodo-in Temple (Uji)</b>                 | JR Nara line from Inari Uji Stn (~15 min). Walk<br>10 min east along river.                                    | On the ¥10 coin! UNESCO. ¥700. Phoenix Hall across<br>pond = iconic image. Get matcha soft serve in Uji —<br>Japan's finest tea region.                |
| 17:30 | <b>Return to Kyoto /<br/>Travel to Osaka</b> | JR Nara line Uji Kyoto (~20 min). Or continue<br>south to Osaka.                                               | If going direct to Osaka: JR from Uji area. Or return to<br>Kyoto, pack, Shinkansen Kyoto Shin-Osaka (15 min,<br>JR Pass).                             |

Check out of Kyoto hotel. Send luggage to Osaka via Takkyubin or carry it. If Takkyubin: arrange night before.

**LUNCH (TBD):** Arashiyama. **Try:** Tofu restaurant or matcha dessert shop. Restaurant: \_\_\_\_\_

**DINNER (TBD):** First Osaka night: Dotonbori appetizer crawl or Kyoto farewell dinner. Restaurant: \_\_\_\_\_

**Also Consider:** Toei Kyoto Studio Park (samurai/ninja theme park, Uzumasa-Koryuji Stn on Randen line — ~30 min from Arashiyama, needs 2–3 hrs)

## Day 12 — Sunday, April 19 — Nara (AM) Osaka (PM)

| Time  | Location / Activity               | Getting There (Exact Directions)                                                                                                                                            | What to Do / Tips                                                                                                                                             |
|-------|-----------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 7:30  | <b>Depart to Nara</b>             | JR Nara line from Kyoto Stn or Osaka area JR Nara Stn (~45 min). Or Kintetsu from Osaka-Namba to Kintetsu Nara Stn (~35 min, closer to deer park). JR Pass covers JR route. |                                                                                                                                                               |
| 8:30  | <b>Todayi-ji Temple</b>           | From JR Nara Stn: walk 20 min east through Noborioji-cho. Or bus #2 to Todayji Daibutsuden stop (10 min).                                                                   | World's largest bronze Buddha (15m) inside world's largest wooden building. ¥600. Squeeze through the nostril pillar (hole in wooden column) = enlightenment! |
| 9:45  | <b>Nara Park</b>                  | Surrounding Todayi-ji and east toward Kasuga Taisha.                                                                                                                        | 1,000+ wild sika deer, bowing for shika-senbei crackers (¥200/stack from vendors). They bow! Watch bags — deer will eat maps/tickets.                         |
| 10:30 | <b>Kasuga Taisha Shrine</b>       | Walk 15 min east through deer park, uphill into primeval forest.                                                                                                            | 3,000 stone + bronze lanterns lining the path. ¥500 inner shrine. Wisteria garden. 768 AD origins.                                                            |
| 12:30 | <b>Train to Osaka</b>             | JR from Nara Osaka/Tennoji (~45 min). Or Kintetsu Nara Osaka-Namba (~35 min).                                                                                               |                                                                                                                                                               |
| 13:30 | <b>Osaka Castle</b>               | JR Osaka Loop line to Osakajoko Stn. Walk 10 min through castle park.                                                                                                       | ¥1,200 castle museum (top floor = city views). Reconstructed 1931, original 1583. Cherry blossom trees in Nishinomaru Garden (¥350).                          |
| 15:00 | <b>Nakanoshima Park</b>           | Walk 20 min west from castle. Or Metro Tanimachi to Kitahama Stn (10 min).                                                                                                  | Island park between two rivers. Rose garden (May peak but nice). Free. Quick rest stop.                                                                       |
| 16:00 | <b>Umeda Sky Building</b>         | Midosuji line from Yodoyabashi Umeda Stn (~5 min). Walk 10 min NW (cross underground tunnel).                                                                               | 'Floating Garden' observatory at 170m. ¥1,500. Connected twin towers with escalator between them. Spectacular at sunset.                                      |
| 17:30 | <b>Shinsekai</b>                  | Midosuji line from Umeda Dobutsuen-mae Stn (~15 min). Exit 1.                                                                                                               | Retro 1912 entertainment district, colorful signs. KUSHIKATSU (deep-fried skewers) capital — never double-dip!                                                |
| 18:00 | <b>Tsutenkaku Tower</b>           | Within Shinsekai, 3 min walk. Can't miss the tower.                                                                                                                         | 103m tower. ¥1,200. Rub Billiken statue's feet for good luck. Retro atmosphere.                                                                               |
| 19:00 | <b>Dotonbori</b>                  | Midosuji line Dobutsuen-mae Namba Stn (~5 min). Exit 14 toward Dotonbori-bashi.                                                                                             | Giant neon signs (Glico Running Man, moving crab, pufferfish). Best street food: takoyaki, gyoza. 'Kuidaore' = eat till you drop!                             |
| 20:30 | <b>Hozen-ji / Hozenji Yokocho</b> | Walk 3 min south from Dotonbori canal into narrow alley.                                                                                                                    | Moss-covered Fudo Myo-o statue. Splash water to make a wish. Beautiful atmospheric alley at night.                                                            |
| 21:00 | <b>Shinsaibashi / Namba</b>       | Walk north from Hozen-ji into Shinsaibashi-suji arcade.                                                                                                                     | 600m covered shopping arcade. Open late. Brands + local shops.                                                                                                |

**LUNCH (TBD):** Nara. **Try:** Kakinoha sushi (mackerel wrapped in persimmon leaf — Nara specialty). Restaurant: \_\_\_\_\_  
**DINNER (TBD):** Dotonbori. **Try:** Takoyaki (octopus balls), okonomiyaki (savory pancake), gyoza. Restaurant: \_\_\_\_\_

**Also Consider:** Mount Yoshino (1.5 hrs each way from Nara via Kintetsu — mountain of 30,000 cherry trees, stunning but eats half the day), Hep Five Ferris Wheel (Umeda, ¥600, indoor ferris wheel near Sky Building — similar views)

## Day 13 — Monday, April 20 — Osaka: Temples, Shrines & Minoo Falls

| Time  | Location / Activity             | Getting There (Exact Directions)                                                                                                  | What to Do / Tips                                                                                                                                        |
|-------|---------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 8:00  | <b>Shitenno-ji Temple</b>       | Tanimachi line from Namba to Shitennoji-mae-Yuhigaoka Stn (~10 min). Walk 5 min south.                                            | Japan's first Buddhist temple (593 AD, Prince Shotoku). ¥300 inner precinct. Five-story pagoda, koi garden.                                              |
| 9:00  | <b>Isshin-ji</b>                | Walk 5 min south from Shitenno-ji along Tanimachi-suji.                                                                           | Unique: bones of 2M+ deceased mixed into Buddha statues displayed at entrance. Peaceful grounds. Free.                                                   |
| 10:00 | <b>Sumiyoshi Taisha Shrine</b>  | Nankai line from Tengachaya Stn Sumiyoshi-Taisha Stn (~10 min). Walk 2 min east.                                                  | One of Japan's oldest shrines (211 AD). Unique Sumiyoshi-zukuri architecture (pre-Chinese influence). Steep arched Taikobashi bridge. Free.              |
| 11:15 | <b>Namba Yasaka Shrine</b>      | Nankai back to Namba (~10 min). Walk 10 min west toward Namba Parks.                                                              | Giant lion head stage (12m tall). Mouth 'swallows evil spirits' and brings good fortune. Free. Great photo.                                              |
| 12:00 | <b>Kuromon Ichiba Market</b>    | Walk 10 min east from Yasaka along Sennichimae-dori.                                                                              | 'Osaka's Kitchen.' 170+ stalls: sea urchin, wagyu beef skewers, king crab legs, mochi. Budget ¥3,000–5,000 for grazing.                                  |
| 13:30 | <b>TeamLab Botanical Garden</b> | Check Nagai Park location. Midosuji line to Nagai Stn or taxi.                                                                    | VERIFY still operating April 2026. Outdoor digital art + botanical garden. Book on Klook if available. Evening is best.                                  |
| 15:30 | <b>Katsuo-ji Temple</b>         | Midosuji line to Senri-Chuo Stn (~25 min). Then Hankyu bus #29 to Katsuo-ji (~30 min). Total ~1 hr.                               | Mountain temple famous for thousands of daruma dolls (red round figures). Paint one eye + make wish; return to paint 2nd eye when wish comes true. ¥400. |
| 17:00 | <b>Minoo Falls</b>              | Walk from Katsuo-ji (~40 min through forest). Or: Hankyu bus back to Senri-Chuo, Hankyu to Minoo Stn, walk 40 min up river trail. | 33m waterfall surrounded by forest. Try momiji tempura (deep-fried maple leaves!) at stalls on the trail. Free.                                          |
| 18:30 | <b>Return to Osaka</b>          | Hankyu Minoo line from Minoo Stn Umeda Stn (~30 min). Then Midosuji to hotel.                                                     |                                                                                                                                                          |

**LUNCH:** Kuromon Ichiba Market (graze: sea urchin, wagyu, crab, mochi). Budget: ¥3,000–5,000

**DINNER (TBD):** Central Osaka. **Try:** Yakiniku (Japanese BBQ). Restaurant: \_\_\_\_\_

**Also Consider:** *The Flavor Design (create custom perfume/scent, Shinsaibashi area, 30–60 min, booking may be needed), Tenjin Bashi Sushi (sushi restaurant)*

## Day 14 — Tuesday, April 21 — Universal Studios Japan (Full Day)

| Time  | Location / Activity            | Getting There (Exact Directions)                                                                                                    | What to Do / Tips                                                                                                                                                                               |
|-------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 7:30  | <b>Depart hotel</b>            | JR Osaka Loop line to Nishikujo Stn JR Yumesaki/Sakurajima line to Universal City Stn (~5 min). Follow the crowds through CityWalk. |                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 8:00  | <b>Universal Studios Japan</b> | Scan Klook QR code at gate. Download USJ official app.                                                                              | BUY TICKETS + EXPRESS PASS ON KLOOK IN ADVANCE. ~¥8,600+ entry + ¥10,000–20,000+ Express Pass. April = very busy. Express Pass is essential to avoid 90+ min waits.                             |
| —     | <b>Super Nintendo World</b>    | Within park. Timed entry via USJ app.                                                                                               | GET TIMED ENTRY via app IMMEDIATELY upon park opening. Without it: 2+ hr wait for area entry alone. Power-Up Band (¥4,200) for interactive coin-collecting games. Mario Kart ride is highlight. |
| —     | <b>Wizarding World of HP</b>   | Within park.                                                                                                                        | Hogwarts ride (Forbidden Journey) = masterpiece. Try Butterbeer (non-alcoholic, ¥700). Ollivanders wand experience (interactive show). Hogsmeade village shops.                                 |
| —     | <b>Minion Park / others</b>    | Within park.                                                                                                                        | Fun themed area with banana food and rides. Also: Jurassic Park, Jaws, Hollywood area.                                                                                                          |
| 19:00 | <b>Exit park</b>               | —                                                                                                                                   |                                                                                                                                                                                                 |
| 19:15 | <b>Universal CityWalk</b>      | Adjacent to park, between station and park gates.                                                                                   | Shopping, restaurants. Takoyaki Museum (multiple takoyaki shops). Good dinner spot.                                                                                                             |
| 20:30 | <b>Return to hotel</b>         | JR Yumesaki from Universal City Nishikujo Osaka Loop.                                                                               | Last night in Osaka. PACK for tomorrow's departure.                                                                                                                                             |

**LUNCH (TBD):** Inside USJ. **Try:** Butterbeer + Three Broomsticks in Harry Potter area. Restaurant: \_\_\_\_\_  
**DINNER (TBD):** Universal CityWalk Takoyaki Museum or central Osaka. Restaurant: \_\_\_\_\_

## Day 15 — Wednesday, April 22 — Travel Home

| Time   | Location / Activity             | Getting There (Exact Directions)                                                                       | What to Do / Tips                                                                                     |
|--------|---------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 7:00   | <b>Check out of Osaka hotel</b> | Carry all luggage.                                                                                     |                                                                                                       |
| 7:30   | <b>Shinkansen to Tokyo</b>      | Walk/metro to Shin-Osaka Stn. Hikari Shinkansen ~2hr40 (JR Pass). Reserve seat in advance via SmartEX. | Buy last ekiben at Shin-Osaka Stn for breakfast/lunch! One last Japanese meal.                        |
| 10:15  | <b>Arrive Tokyo Station</b>     | Exit to JR platform for N'EX.                                                                          |                                                                                                       |
| 10:30  | <b>Narita Express to NRT</b>    | N'EX Tokyo Stn Narita T1. ~53 min. ¥3,250 each way. Reserve online.                                    |                                                                                                       |
| 11:30  | <b>Arrive Narita T1</b>         | Go to Zipair check-in counter.                                                                         | Check in. Duty-free shopping: Japanese snacks, sake, matcha, limited-edition KitKats! Last souvenirs. |
| 15:55  | <b>Depart NRT (ZG022)</b>       | Zipair Vancouver. ~8hr35.                                                                              | Cross date line eastbound: arrive same calendar day.                                                  |
| ~08:30 | <b>Arrive Vancouver (YVR)</b>   | —                                                                                                      | Same day (Wed Apr 22). Welcome home!                                                                  |

## Pre-Booking & Tickets (Klook + Direct)

Book through Klook (klook.com) wherever possible for convenience, mobile QR entry, and bundle discounts. Items marked are time-sensitive.

| Item                    | When to Book              | Est. Cost        | Platform & Steps                                                                         |
|-------------------------|---------------------------|------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| teamLab Borderless      | 12 wks ahead (Jan 2026)   | ¥3,800           | Klook (exclusive partner). Select date + 30-min entry slot. QR ticket on phone.          |
| Tokyo Disney            | ASAP (sells out)          | ¥7,900–10,900    | Klook or tokyodisneyresort.jp. If card declined on TDR, use Klook. Scan QR into TDR app. |
| USJ Entry Ticket        | ASAP                      | ~¥8,600+         | Klook or usj.co.jp. QR on phone. Download USJ app for timed entries.                     |
| USJ Express Pass        | ASAP (sells out fast)     | ¥10,000–20,000+  | Klook. ESSENTIAL for Nintendo World + HP. Without it: 90+ min queues.                    |
| JR Pass (14-day)        | Before departure          | ~¥80,000         | Klook or japanrailpass.net. Receive voucher exchange at Narita JR counter.               |
| eSIM (14-day unlimited) | Before departure          | ~¥2,000–4,000    | Klook: DOCOMO or SoftBank eSIM. Install QR before flight. Activate on landing.           |
| Shibuya Sky             | 1–2 weeks ahead           | ¥2,000           | Klook. Select date + time. QR entry.                                                     |
| Tokyo Skytree           | 1–2 weeks ahead           | ¥2,100–3,400     | Klook. Tembo Deck (¥2,100) or combo with Galleria (¥3,400).                              |
| Mt. Fuji Highway Bus    | 1–2 weeks ahead           | ¥2,200 one-way   | highway-buses.jp or Klook. Shinjuku (Busta) Kawaguchiko.                                 |
| Shinkansen Seats        | Anytime (free w/ JR Pass) | Free reservation | SmartEX app or JR ticket machines/counter at station. Reserve Hikari only.               |
| TeamLab Botanical       | Check availability        | TBD              | Klook. Verify still operating Apr 2026 at Nagai Park, Osaka.                             |
| Art Aquarium Ginza      | Optional                  | ~¥2,500          | Klook or on-site. Verify still open Apr 2026.                                            |

## Paid Entry (No Advance Booking Needed — Pay at Door)

| Location              | Cost   | Location                | Cost      |
|-----------------------|--------|-------------------------|-----------|
| Kiyomizu-dera         | ¥500   | Osaka Castle            | ¥1,200    |
| Kodai-ji              | ¥600   | Umeda Sky Building      | ¥1,500    |
| Sanjusangen-do        | ¥600   | Tsutenkaku Tower        | ¥1,200    |
| Kinkaku-ji            | ¥500   | Katsuo-ji               | ¥400      |
| Ryoan-ji              | ¥500   | Iwatayama Monkey Park   | ¥550      |
| Ninna-ji              | ¥800   | Great Buddha (Kamakura) | ¥300      |
| Nijo Castle           | ¥1,300 | Shinjuku Gyoen          | ¥500      |
| Byodo-in (Uji)        | ¥700   | Kiyosumi Garden         | ¥150      |
| Todai-ji              | ¥600   | Nanzen-ji hall          | ¥600      |
| Kasuga Taisha (inner) | ¥500   | Daitoku-ji sub-temples  | ¥400 each |

## Hotel Bookings

April is peak season (cherry blossoms + Golden Week shoulder). Book early for best rates. Free cancellation policies recommended.

| City  | Nights | Dates     | Recommended Areas & Why                                                                                                                                           | Hotel | Conf # |
|-------|--------|-----------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-------|--------|
| Tokyo | 6      | Apr 9–15  | <b>Shinjuku</b> (best transit hub, JR + metro, nightlife)<br><b>Asakusa</b> (budget, near Senso-ji/Skytree, local feel)<br><b>Shibuya</b> (trendy, younger crowd) | ----- | -----  |
| Kyoto | 3      | Apr 15–18 | <b>Kyoto Station area</b> (best transit, bus hub)<br><b>Gion/Higashiyama</b> (atmospheric, walk to temples)<br><b>Kawaramachi</b> (central, shopping, Pontocho)   | ----- | -----  |
| Osaka | 3      | Apr 18–21 | <b>Namba/Dotonbori</b> (food capital, nightlife, central)<br><b>Shinsaibashi</b> (shopping, between Namba & Umeda)                                                | ----- | -----  |

### Booking Tips:

- Check Booking.com, Agoda, Hotels.com, and hotel direct sites. Compare prices.
- Consider 1 night in a ryokan (traditional inn with tatami, futon, onsen bath) in Kyoto. Budget ¥15,000–30,000/night.
- Most Japanese hotels allow early luggage drop even before check-in time.
- Budget: ¥8,000–15,000/night for mid-range. ¥20,000+ for premium. ¥4,000–7,000 for hostels.
- Look for hotels with coin laundry (very common in Japan) — essential for 15-day trip.

## Meal Planning Guide

Green boxes on each day mark meal slots with suggestions. Below: must-try foods by city with context.

| City          | Must-Try Foods                                                                                                                                                         | Tips & Context                                                                                                                                                 |
|---------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Tokyo         | Ramen (tonkotsu, shoyu, miso, tsukemen), sushi (conveyor belt or omakase), monjayaki, yakitori, tonkatsu, tempura, wagashi (traditional sweets)                        | Tabelog app is Japan's most trusted restaurant review platform (more reliable than Google). Rating 3.5+ = excellent. 3.7+ = exceptional. Download before trip. |
| Kamakura      | Shirasu-don (raw whitebait rice bowl)                                                                                                                                  | Kamakura's signature dish. Best fresh from the port. Available on Komachi-dori.                                                                                |
| Mt. Fuji area | Houtou noodles (thick flat wheat in miso with pumpkin)                                                                                                                 | Yamanashi regional specialty. Warming and hearty. Every restaurant near Kawaguchiko serves it.                                                                 |
| Kyoto         | Yudofu (simmered tofu), matcha everything (parfaits, soft serve, lattes), kaiseki (multi-course haute cuisine), obanzai (home-style Kyoto dishes), tsukemono (pickles) | Kyoto = refined cuisine. Kaiseki is a splurge (¥10,000–20,000) but an unforgettable experience. Nishiki Market is best for snacking.                           |
| Nara          | Kakinoha sushi (mackerel pressed sushi in persimmon leaves)                                                                                                            | Ancient preservation technique. Unique to Nara/Yoshino region.                                                                                                 |
| Osaka         | Takoyaki (octopus balls), okonomiyaki (savory pancake — Osaka-style), kushikatsu (deep-fried skewers — NEVER double-dip!), kitsune udon, gyoza, yakiniku               | 'Kuidaore' = eat till you drop. Osaka = Japan's food capital. Dotonbori and Kuromon are the epicenters. Street food budget: ¥3,000–5,000.                      |



# Trip Cost Summary

All prices in Japanese Yen (¥). Verified as of Jan/Feb 2026. 1 CAD ≈ ¥105–110.

**JR Pass Warning:** The 14-day JR Pass is now ¥80,000 (70% price hike in Oct 2023). For THIS itinerary, individual tickets cost ~¥47,000 total — saving ~¥33,000 vs. the pass. **Buy Shinkansen tickets individually via SmartEX app instead.**

## Transit & Passes

| Item                                       | Cost (per person)    | Notes                                   |
|--------------------------------------------|----------------------|-----------------------------------------|
| OPTION A: JR Pass 14-day                   | ¥80,000              | NOT recommended for this trip.          |
| OPTION B: Individual tickets (RECOMMENDED) | ~¥47,000 total       | SmartEX app. Saves ~¥33,000 vs JR Pass. |
| Narita Express (round trip)                | ~¥6,500              | Alt: Keisei Skyliner ¥2,520 each way.   |
| Tokyo Kyoto Shinkansen (Hikari)            | ~¥13,320             | SmartEX app.                            |
| Shin-Osaka Tokyo Shinkansen                | ~¥13,870             | SmartEX app.                            |
| JR Yokosuka: Tokyo Kamakura RT             | ~¥1,840              |                                         |
| JR Nara line: Kyoto Nara RT                | ~¥1,420              |                                         |
| JR: Nara Osaka                             | ~¥810                |                                         |
| JR local lines in Tokyo (6 days)           | ~¥3,000              | Varies by usage.                        |
| Suica/Pasmo IC card (metro, buses)         | ¥5,000–10,000 total  | Load as needed. ¥500 deposit.           |
| Kyoto Bus Day Pass (3 days)                | ¥700 x 3 = ¥2,100    | Essential for temple hopping.           |
| Mt. Fuji highway bus (round trip)          | ~¥4,400              | Shinjuku Kawaguchiko return.            |
| Takkyubin luggage forwarding (x2)          | ~¥2,000 x 2 = ¥4,000 | TokyoKyoto + KyotoOsaka.                |

## Tickets & Admissions (Day by Day)

| Day | Attraction               | Cost          | Notes (free items nearby)           |
|-----|--------------------------|---------------|-------------------------------------|
| 2   | Senso-ji / Asakusa       | FREE          | Nakamise shopping street free.      |
| 3   | Ueno Park + Ameyoko      | FREE          | Yanaka Ginza free.                  |
| 3   | Gotokuji Temple          | FREE          | Maneki-neko (buy ¥300–5,000).       |
| 4   | Meiji Shrine             | FREE          | Harajuku Takeshita St free.         |
| 4   | Shibuya Sky              | ¥3,000–3,700  | Book on Klook.                      |
| 5   | Art Aquarium Ginza       | ¥2,500        |                                     |
| 5   | teamLab Borderless       | ¥3,800–4,800  | Book 2 months ahead on teamlab.art. |
| 6   | Tokyo Disney             | ¥7,900–10,900 | April peak pricing.                 |
| 7   | Great Buddha Kamakura    | ¥300          | Tsurugaoka Hachimangu free.         |
| 7   | Hase-dera                | ¥400          |                                     |
| 8   | Mt. Fuji 5th Station bus | ~¥3,080 RT    | If road open. (cost above).         |
| 9   | Kiyomizu-dera            | ¥500          | Sannenzaka, Gion, Hanamikoji free.  |
| 9   | Kodai-ji                 | ¥600          |                                     |
| 9   | Sanjusangen-do           | ¥600          |                                     |
| 10  | Kinkaku-ji               | ¥500          |                                     |
| 10  | Ryoan-ji                 | ¥500          |                                     |

|    |                    |                  |                                |
|----|--------------------|------------------|--------------------------------|
| 10 | Ninna-ji           | ¥500             |                                |
| 10 | Nijo Castle        | ¥1,300           | Nishiki Market free.           |
| 11 | Fushimi Inari      | FREE             | Bamboo Grove, Togetsukyo free. |
| 11 | Byodo-in (Uji)     | ¥700             |                                |
| 12 | Todai-ji (Nara)    | ¥600             | Nara Park + deer free.         |
| 12 | Osaka Castle       | ¥1,200           | Nakanoshima Park free.         |
| 12 | Umeda Sky Building | ¥1,500           |                                |
| 12 | Tsutenkaku Tower   | ¥1,200           | Shinsekai free.                |
| 13 | Shitenno-ji        | ¥300             |                                |
| 13 | Sumiyoshi Taisha   | FREE             |                                |
| 13 | Minoo Falls        | FREE             |                                |
| 13 | Katsuo-ji Temple   | ¥400             |                                |
| 14 | USJ Studio Pass    | ~¥8,600+         | Dynamic pricing.               |
| 14 | USJ Express Pass 7 | ~¥10,000–20,000+ | Essential for Nintendo World.  |
| 14 | USJ Power-Up Band  | ¥4,200           | For Mario Kart interactive.    |

### Grand Total Estimate (Per Person)

| Category                       | Budget    | Mid-Range | Notes                                 |
|--------------------------------|-----------|-----------|---------------------------------------|
| Transit (Option B: individual) | ~¥60,000  | ~¥65,000  | IC card + buses + Shinkansen          |
| Tickets & Admissions           | ~¥37,000  | ~¥48,000  | All temples + Disney + USJ w/ Express |
| Accommodation (12 nights)      | ~¥96,000  | ~¥200,000 | Budget hotel vs. mid-range            |
| Meals (13 days)                | ~¥48,000  | ~¥130,000 | Konbini/ramen vs. restaurants         |
| Misc (souvenirs, SIM, etc.)    | ~¥15,000  | ~¥30,000  | eSIM ~¥3,000. Souvenirs vary.         |
| TOTAL (excl. flights)          | ~¥256,000 | ~¥473,000 | ~CAD \$2,350–\$4,350                  |

|                    |                               |                               |                                            |
|--------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| <b>GRAND TOTAL</b> | <b>~CAD<br/>\$2,950–3,250</b> | <b>~CAD<br/>\$4,950–5,250</b> | <b>Per person, all-inclusive estimate.</b> |
|--------------------|-------------------------------|-------------------------------|--------------------------------------------|

**Key finding:** The JR Pass (14-day) at ¥80,000 is NOT worth it for this itinerary. Individual Shinkansen tickets total ~¥47,000, saving ~¥33,000. Use SmartEX app to book.

**Money-saving tips:** 7-Eleven ATMs accept foreign cards (best rates). Many temples/shrines are free. Konbini meals are excellent and cheap (¥300–800). Tax-free shopping at Don Quijote/Uniqlo over ¥5,000 (bring passport). Download Tabelog for restaurant reviews.

# Complete Planning Checklist

## Before Departure — Digital Setup

### Register on Visit Japan Web (vjw.digital.go.jp)

Create account Add trip (flight ZG021, Apr 9 arrival, Narita) Fill disembarkation card + customs declaration Generate QR codes. Complete 48+ hrs before flight. QR must be shown live on phone (screenshots NOT accepted). Have internet at airport (eSIM or WiFi).

### Buy eSIM on Klook (14-day DOCOMO or SoftBank unlimited data)

Purchase on Klook Receive QR code via email/app Install eSIM on phone BEFORE flying (needs WiFi) Activate cellular data + roaming ON after landing in Japan. Keep original SIM active for calls home.

### Download essential apps: Klook, TDR (Tokyo Disney Resort), USJ Official, SmartEX (Shinkansen), Tabelog

(restaurants), Google Maps (download Japan offline map), Google Translate (download Japanese offline pack)

All free. TDR app needed for Disney DPA/standby passes. USJ app needed for Nintendo World timed entry. SmartEX for Shinkansen seat reservations. Tabelog for restaurant reviews (3.5+ = great).

## Flights & Transit

### Confirm ZG021/ZG022 Zipair flights + seat selection

Pre-order meals on zipair.net if desired (no free meals). Select seats. Print/save boarding passes.

### Research JR Pass vs individual tickets (SmartEX app)

Receive exchange voucher Activate at JR East Travel Center in Narita T1 arrivals. Covers: all Shinkansen (Hikari/Sakura only, NOT Nozomi), JR local trains, Narita Express, some JR buses. ~¥80,000.

### Book Mt. Fuji highway bus (Shinjuku Kawaguchiko, round-trip)

Book at highway-buses.jp or Klook. ~¥2,200 one-way. Busta Shinjuku (4F) departure.

### Check Mt. Fuji 5th Station road status (late March 2026)

Subaru Line (toll road to 5th Station) may not open until late April due to snow. Check fujiyama-navi.jp. Backup: stay in Kawaguchiko lakeside area, visit Oshino Hakkai springs.

## Accommodations

### Book Tokyo hotel — 6 nights: Apr 9–15

Recommended: Shinjuku area (best JR/metro hub). Budget ¥8,000–15,000/night. Check Booking.com, Agoda, hotel direct sites.

### Book Kyoto hotel — 3 nights: Apr 15–18

Recommended: Near Kyoto Station (bus hub for temples). Consider 1 ryokan night for the experience (¥15,000–30,000).

### Book Osaka hotel — 3 nights: Apr 18–21

Recommended: Namba/Dotonbori (central for food, nightlife, USJ access).

### Confirm all hotels allow early luggage drop + late check-in

### Look for hotels with coin laundry (common, essential for 15-day trip)

## Tickets & Reservations (Time-Sensitive!)

### teamLab Borderless — Book on Klook 12 weeks ahead (January 2026)

Klook is exclusive ticketing partner. Select date + 30-min time slot. ¥3,800. Sells out fast for weekends. Wear pants (mirrored floors).

### Tokyo Disney — Book on Klook ASAP

Decide: DisneySea (recommended for adults) vs Disneyland (classics). ¥9,400–10,900. Scan Klook QR into TDR app. Use app for DPA (¥2,000/ride fastpass) and standby passes.

### USJ tickets + Express Pass — Book on Klook ASAP

Entry: ¥8,600–9,800. Express Pass: ¥7,800–15,000+. Express Pass is ESSENTIAL for Super Nintendo World timed entry + Forbidden Journey. Without Express Pass: 90+ min queues. Buy Power-Up Band separately at park (¥4,200).

### Shibuya Sky — Book on Klook 1–2 weeks ahead (¥2,000)

### Tokyo Skytree — Book on Klook 1–2 weeks ahead (¥2,100–3,400)

### TeamLab Botanical (Osaka) — Verify still operating Apr 2026, book on Klook if available

### Art Aquarium Ginza — Verify still open Apr 2026

## Meal Planning

### Research + bookmark restaurants for each day (use Tabelog app)

Focus on: 1 special kaiseki dinner in Kyoto (¥10,000–20,000, book 2–4 weeks ahead), ramen shops in Tokyo, okonomiyaki in Osaka.

### Fill in the meal placeholder blanks in each day's itinerary

### Pre-order Zipair in-flight meals or plan to bring food from YVR

Zipair has no free food. Options: pre-order on [zipair.net](https://zipair.net) or buy food at YVR before boarding.

## Packing Essentials

- Passport + 2 photocopies (keep separate from original)
- Travel insurance documentation (print or save offline)
- Comfortable walking shoes (15,000–25,000 steps/day!)
- Light rain jacket or compact umbrella (April showers common)
- Small daypack for daily sightseeing
- Portable battery charger (20,000mAh recommended)
- Pants/shorts that cover knees for teamLab Borderless (mirrored floors)
- Cash: withdraw ¥30,000–50,000 at 7-Eleven ATM upon arrival (accepts foreign cards)
  - Japan is still cash-heavy at temples, shrines, small restaurants, and market stalls. 7-Eleven, Lawson, and Japan Post ATMs all accept international cards.
- No power adapter needed — Japan uses Type A plugs (same as North America, 100V)

## Luggage Logistics

- Day 8 (Apr 15): Send bags Tokyo Kyoto via Takkyubin (~¥2,000)
  - Arrange at hotel front desk the night before. Yamato Transport (black cat logo) or Sagawa. Arrives next day. Travel light to Mt. Fuji with daypack only.
- Day 11 (Apr 18): Send bags Kyoto Osaka via Takkyubin or use coin lockers
  - Coin lockers: ¥400–700 at Kyoto/Osaka stations. Or Takkyubin same-day if arranged early morning.
- Day 15 (Apr 22): Carry all luggage on Shinkansen Osaka Tokyo Narita (overhead racks fit carry-on suitcases)

## Optional / Still Deciding

- DisneySea vs. Disneyland — decide which park (DisneySea recommended for adults)
- Verify Art Aquarium Ginza + TeamLab Botanical still operating April 2026
- Check cherry blossom forecast ([sakura.weathermap.jp](https://sakura.weathermap.jp), late March 2026)
- Review all 'Also Consider' (yellow box) locations — add on the ground if time allows
- Okinawa removed from this trip — consider for a future 3+ day dedicated trip
- Consider Klook Pass Greater Tokyo if visiting 3+ Klook attractions (bundle discount)